

Reasoning & Assumptions

Workbook 2 - Apply - Focused practice

Directions

Treat each item as close-choice practice. Preserve scope, certainty, and the exact job of each piece of evidence.

Exercise 1

A council member says a new downtown parking fee will reduce traffic because one neighboring city saw traffic fall after adopting a similar fee. The neighboring city also opened a rail station that month.

Task: Which statement best identifies the reasoning weakness?

- A. The argument assumes the parking fee caused the decline without separating the effect of the new rail station.
- B. The neighboring city is mentioned by name.
- C. Parking fees can never affect traffic.
- D. Traffic data are always unreliable.

Exercise 2

A supervisor says, "If employees may choose one remote day, teamwork will collapse because people will stop communicating."

Task: Which assumption is necessary for that prediction?

- A. Remote work necessarily prevents effective communication.
- B. Employees use computers.
- C. The office has meeting rooms.
- D. Some employees commute.

Exercise 3

A school compares its new reading program with a program used at a much smaller private school and assumes similar results will occur.

Task: What additional evidence would most strengthen the comparison?

- A. Evidence that the schools have similar student populations, staffing, and implementation conditions.
- B. The private school's mascot.
- C. The age of the school buildings.
- D. A list of unrelated extracurricular activities.

Exercise 4

A manager argues that complaints fell after a new script was introduced, so the script should be used company-wide. The trial involved one experienced team for ten days.

Task: Which conclusion follows most reasonably?

- A. The script may be promising, but a broader trial is needed before a company-wide conclusion.
- B. The script has been proven universally effective.
- C. Experienced teams should never test new tools.
- D. Complaint data are irrelevant to customer service.

Answer reasoning

Check your reasoning, not only your answer.

For every question, compare your reasoning with the explanation. If you missed the item, identify the exact step where your reasoning changed the source or used evidence for the wrong job.

Exercise 1

Best answer: A. The argument assumes the parking fee caused the decline without separating the effect of the new rail station.

Why: The alternative change makes the single-cause conclusion uncertain.

Exercise 2

Best answer: A. Remote work necessarily prevents effective communication.

Why: The prediction depends on treating remote work as incompatible with communication, which the statement does not establish.

Exercise 3

Best answer: A. Evidence that the schools have similar student populations, staffing, and implementation conditions.

Why: A comparison is stronger when the factors relevant to the outcome are similar.

Exercise 4

Best answer: A. The script may be promising, but a broader trial is needed before a company-wide conclusion.

Why: It respects the positive result while recognizing the limited duration and group.

Mistake check

For every miss, label the reason: wrong claim, evidence mismatch, too broad or too certain, reasoning gap, source or format confusion, or rushed reading. Then write one sentence explaining what you will check next time.